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Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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General Comment

This proposal claims that we need to unburden "AI" (a vague term referring to a broad range of technologies) in order to "promote human flourishing, economic competitiveness, and national security." As a longtime professional with a career in creative technology, I can clearly see how this proposal would not only fail to achieve those goals, but do massive and irreparable damage to America in all of those areas.

These technologies are already flush with funding from many of the largest companies and investors in the US and abroad. They are not particularly burdened by any special regulations. They fill the booths at CES (the primary consumer electronics trade show) and the ad spots at the Super Bowl. Despite all of this they are deeply unprofitable, not widely adopted by consumers, and have little demonstrable use for governments.

Proponents of these technologies make wild claims about their future capabilities, but those capabilities have not materialized and there's no indication that they will. Even if they do, we should require that projects actually demonstrate these capabilities before we make sweeping legal changes to support them.

If we remove the "burdensome requirements" of foundational concepts like copyright and intellectual property from these companies, they will no doubt profit in the short term - as any thief will profit from a windfall of stolen goods. When the government protects thieves they declare that there is no value in creation, in innovation. It would destroy vast sectors of American industry without providing any lasting value. Those real, productive creative industries WILL grow elsewhere without us - leaving us uncompetitive, insecure and destitute.